

BRAD ASH

Minneapolis, MN • (703) 317-7159 • bradley.ash@gmail.com • unforgivn.github.io

Strategic technology executive and solution architect with 20+ years of experience scaling engineering organizations, driving efficiency, optimizing costs, and leading digital transformation. Expert in bridging the gap between technical execution and business strategy, with a proven track record of building inspired cultures, unlocking delivery throughput, and architecting enterprise-grade software platforms.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wpromote, *VP of Engineering*

04/2024 - Present

- Spearheaded the evolution of proprietary Polaris platform into a client-facing SaaS web app; delivered on schedule, with 87% client adoption, 2x NPS targets, and 300% ROI in our first year of tracking sales attribution to Polaris.
- Scaled the engineering department from 12 to 40 and restructured into high-velocity squads; increased individual engineer throughput by 60% while achieving the top employee engagement score (eNPS 71).
- Executed a strategic FinOps overhaul that reduced infrastructure costs by 20%, cut \$400k/yr in under-utilized SaaS, and unlocked over \$2.5M in CapEx for us to reinvest in personnel and AI growth.
- Bolstered Airflow pipelines to increase data freshness by 400%, while reducing production incidents by 32%.
- Architected Google Cloud Foundation in Terraform to manage governance, security, budgets, and automated provisioning of all cloud infrastructure.
- Modernized the SDLC by migrating to GitHub and custom DevOps and AI tooling; 3x deployment frequency while automating quality gates, code reviews, and deployments for crown jewel applications.
- Built agent orchestration platform to centralize fragmented AI workflows in a secure, scalable, and observable system.
- Migrated brownfield data stores to a new, agent-ready warehouse schema on GCP that cut BigQuery costs by 50%.
- Maintained active technical leadership (1,300 GitHub contributions in 2025 and 3,500 so far in 2026), architecting all our GitOps repositories, serverless monorepo with automated release pipelines, event-driven services, and an enterprise Kubernetes cluster.
- Led technical partnerships with Google, Meta, Pinterest, Amazon, Snapchat, and TikTok, securing \$3M in funding to accelerate R&D and bring AI-driven features like *Creative Audit* intelligence suite and *Bid Budget Optimizer* to market.

lululemon, Seattle, *Technology Director, Cloud Platform*

02/2023 - 04/2024

- Managed a global, high-performance team of 5 managers and 30 senior individual contributors to deliver enterprise cloud platforms. Mentored technical leadership on the team while fostering our culture and values.
- Provided vision and leadership to deliver best-in-class enterprise cloud platform services on AWS and Azure for a global retailer with \$10B in sales.
- Delivered \$6M in FinOps savings through cleanup and right-sizing of cloud resources in the first 6 months (2x OKR).
- Developed strategic plans, roadmaps, and business cases in collaboration with technology leaders and architects for platform landing zones, shared tools, automation, self-service catalog, governance, cost optimization, and security.
- Improved product-delivery model for cloud platform and measured customer experience through meaningful performance and operational SLAs.
- Worked closely with CISO to drive compliance: SOC 2, PCI, CIS, and enterprise engineering RFCs.

Capitol Information Group, *Chief Technology Officer*

03/2020 - 02/2023

- Drove innovation for 5 publishing companies (2M subscribers, \$50M revenue). Led due diligence on acquisitions, identifying data insights that paid off the debt a year early.

- Migrated high-traffic services to AWS/GCP, reducing data center overhead and implementing a federated data lakehouse for better governance.
- Ran weekly senior leadership team (SLT) meetings to maintain accountability and visibility into projects across the entire company.
- Principal architect for major systems, mentoring seniors and leveling up the team as a hands-on leader.

Capitol Information Group, *Director of Engineering / Principal Engineer*

09/2017 - 03/2020

- Increased online sales by 20% annually via new upsell/cross-sell checkout flows.
- Expanded solutions teams, doubling engineering headcount and establishing a dedicated data engineering function.
- Led the 5-year roadmap to deprecate legacy monoliths in favor of a microservice architecture.

Capitol Information Group, *Previous Roles: Software Engineer to Engineering Manager*

05/2006 - 09/2017

- Promoted through ranks of Software Engineer and Manager based on performance, leading the tech org in adoption of open-source infrastructure, SDLC automation, test-driven development, and building custom SaaS solutions.

STARTUPS

Fruitful Fertility, *Co-Founder / Chief Technology Officer / Principal Engineer*

11/2016 - 04/2021

- Built an algorithmic matching engine (10k users) and secured \$100k pre-seed investment. Pivoted B2B to B2C during the pandemic before exiting.

Baton Investing, *Founder / Principal Engineer*

05/2014 - 10/2016

- Incubated a FinTech spin-off using Lean Startup methodology; maintained positive cost-to-revenue ratios for templatable products.

SKILLS

Strategic Leadership: FinOps, Distributed Teams, Product Development, Managing Contractors, M&A Due Diligence, Governance, Risk, and Compliance, Agile SDLC Transformation, Vendor Management, Scalability, Resiliency

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS Certified Solutions Architect (2023), MS Certified Azure Admin (2023), Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform Associate (2024), Serverless, Lambda, Argo CD, Microservices, GitOps, CI/CD

Data & Storage: BigQuery, Snowflake SnowPro Core (2023), Databricks, S3, GCS, Iceberg, Redshift, PostgreSQL, MySQL, DuckDB, Redis, dbt, Kafka, ksqldb, Spark, Beam, Airflow, SSIS, SQS, Pub/Sub, Looker, Cube, Tableau, Power BI

AI & ML: Ray, MLFlow, Vertex AI, Bedrock, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, Agent Frameworks, vector dbs

OOP & Scripting: Python, Go, Node.js, Java, TypeScript, React.js, React Native, PHP, Ruby, C, Bash, REST/Graph APIs, TDD

Observability & Tools: Datadog, Splunk, Prometheus, Elasticsearch, Loki, Grafana, Open Telemetry, Sentry, JIRA

COMMUNITY & PROFILE

Leadership: Eagle Scout · Order of the Arrow · MPLS Ward 7 Neighborhood President · Lululemon DEI Council

Strengths Finder: Achiever · Command · Focus · Futuristic · Woo

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science + UI / Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY